Artistic Photography

H 1255

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A. Background

LC practice: As stated in H 1075, LC catalogers will no longer use form subdivisions. Instead assign an appropriate term or terms from Library of Congress Genre/Form Terms (LCGFT), e.g. ***Textbooks***. To replace a form subdivision that includes a demographic group, also assign Library of Congress Demographic Groups Terms (LCDGT) to bring out the audience of the resource being cataloged, e.g. ***German speakers*** or ***Arabic, Students of***.

For guidelines on works about art, see H 1250. For guidelines on works about illustrations, see H 1659. For guidelines on works about pictorial works, see H 1935. For guidelines on works on exhibitions, see H 1593.

B. Recent revisions

2026-07: Updated template. Added alternative instructions for LCGFT implementation.

C. Definitions

Artistic photography: photography used for creative expression and treated as a fine art.

D. General works on artistic photography

Assign the heading ***Photography, Artistic*** to works that consist chiefly of photographs whose main purpose is photography as a fine art. Assign the heading also to general discussions of artistic photography.

LC practice: Assign the subject heading ***Photography, Artistic*** for works that are chiefly collections of or reproductions of photographs whose main purpose is photography as a fine art. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Illustrated works***.

Example:

```
Title: Great unknowns : an exquisite collection of black and white photography.
   650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic.
LC practice:
   650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic.
   655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft
```

E. Artistic photography from a particular place

Do not divide the heading ***Photography, Artistic*** by place. To express the geographic origin of the photographs, assign an additional subject heading ***Photography--[place]***.

Example:

```
Title: Visual instincts : contemporary Australian photography.
   650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic.
   650 #0 $a Photography $z Australia.
LC practice:
   650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic.
   650 #0 $a Photography $z Australia.
   655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft
```

F. Artistic photography from a particular time period

Assign the heading ***Photography, Artistic***, subdivided by period subdivisions from the free-floating list in H 1148. Do not interpose the subdivision ***--History***.

Example:

Title: Present perfect.

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic $y 20th century.

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic $y 21st century.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic $y 20th century.

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic $y 21st century.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

G. Special types of photography

For works on or photographic collections of special types of photography, assign the specific heading that best represents that type of photography, for example, ***Landscape photography***; ***Fashion photography***; ***Photography, Humorous***. For portrait photography, see Sec. I, below.

LC practice: Assign the subject heading for the type of artistic photography for works that are chiefly collections of or reproductions of photographs with a specific focus. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT *** Illustrated works ***.

Example:

Title: The field guide of photographing landscapes.

650 #0 $a Landscape photography.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Landscape photography.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

Title: Vogue book of fashion photography, 1919-1979.

650 #0 $a Fashion photography.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Fashion photography.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

H. Photography of specific items, places, etc.

Determine whether the focus of the piece is on artistic photography or on the actual items, places, etc. If the primary focus is artistic photography, assign a heading for photography of the topic, for example, ***Photography of mountains**; **Dance photography***. Assign additional headings for the topic with the form subdivision ***--Pictorial works***. For works that merely

contain photographs depicting a topic or place and are of interest primarily for the pictorial information presented, see H 1935.

LC practice: For works that are chiefly collections of or reproductions of photographs with a specific focus, first determine if the focus of the work is on artistic photography. If so, assign the subject heading for the topical focus, for example, ***Photography of mountains**; **Dance photography***. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***** **Illustrated works** *****.

LC practice: For guidelines on works that merely contain photographs depicting a topic or place and are of interest primarily for the pictorial information presented, see H 1935.

Example:

Title: City cats.

650 #0 $a Photography of cats.

650 #0 $a Cats $v Pictorial works.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography of cats.

650 #0 $a Cats.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

Title: The American family : a pictorial celebration.

650 #0 $a Photography of families.

650 #0 $a Families $z United States $v Pictorial works.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography of families.

650 #0 $a Families $z United States.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

I. Portrait photography

For works on or general collections of portrait photographs, assign the heading ***Portrait photography***. If a specific class of persons is represented, assign a heading for that class of persons subdivided by ***--Portraits***, with ***Portrait photography*** as an additional heading. If there is an existing heading of the type ***Photography of [class of persons]*** assign that heading instead of ***Portrait photography*** and, if the visual identity of the individuals is emphasized, assign an additional heading for class of persons with subdivision ***--Portraits***. For works that contain portraits primarily as visual representations of persons without emphasis on photography, see H 1935.

LC practice: For works that are chiefly collections of or reproductions of photographs that are portraits, assign of subject heading for the focus of the portraits. If a specific class of persons is represented, assign a heading for that class of persons, with ***Portrait photography*** as an additional heading. If there is an existing heading of the type ***Photography of [class of persons]*** assign that heading instead of ***Portrait photography***. Assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***** **Illustrated works** *****.

LC practice: For guidelines on works that contain portraits primarily as visual representations of persons without emphasis on photography, see H 1935.

Example:

Title: The joy of photographing people.

[text on how to take portraits with some illustrations]

650 #0 $a Portrait photography.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Portrait photography.

655 #7 $a Portraits. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

Title: Picturing us : African American identity in photography.

650 #0 $a African Americans.

650 #0 $a Portrait photography.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a African Americans.

650 #0 $a Portrait photography.

655 #7 $a Portraits. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

Title: The American woman : a pictorial celebration.

650 #0 $a Photography of women.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography of women.

655 #7 $a Portraits. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

Title: Children of the past in photographic portraits.

650 #0 $a Photography of children.

650 #0 $a Children $v Portraits.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography of children.

650 #0 $a Children.

655 #7 $a Portraits. $2 lcgft

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

J. Collections of artistic photography by one photographer

For collections of photographs by one photographer, assign the heading ***Photography, Artistic***, or other subject heading for type of photography or theme, with an additional heading for the name of the photographer.

Example:

Title: Ancestral dialogues : the photographs of Albert Chong.

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic.

600 10 $a Chong, Albert.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

Title: Fashion photography, Patrick Demarchelier.

650 #0 $a Fashion photography.

600 10 $a Demarchelier, Patrick.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Fashion photography.

600 10 $a Demarchelier, Patrick.

655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft

Title: Portrait Hollywood : Gary Bernstein's classic celebrity photographs.

650 #0 $a Celebrities $z United States $v Portraits.

650 #0 $a Portrait photography $z United States.

600 10 $a Bernstein, Gary.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Celebrities $z United States.

```
650 #0 $a Portrait photography $z United States.
600 10 $a Bernstein, Gary.
655 #7 $a Portraits. $2 lcgft
655 #7 $a Illustrated works. $2 lcgft
```

K. Exhibition catalogs

For an exhibition catalog of artistic photographs, not limited to a particular theme or type of photography, assign the subject heading ***Photography, Artistic--Exhibitions***. For an exhibition catalog of photographs on a particular theme or photography of a particular type, assign a heading for the theme or type, for example, ***Photography of clouds--Exhibitions***; ***Glamour photography--Exhibitions***.

LC practice: For an exhibition catalog of artistic photographs, not limited to a particular theme or type of photography, assign the subject heading ***Photography, Artistic***. For an exhibition catalog of photographs on a particular theme or photography of a particular type, assign a heading for the theme or type, for example, ***Photography of clouds***. Also assign LCGFT appropriate to the form and/or genre of the resource in hand, e.g. LCGFT ***Exhibition catalogs***.

K.1. Works of one photographer

If the exhibition consists of works by one photographer, assign an additional heading for the name of the photographer with subdivision ***--Exhibitions***.

LC practice: If the exhibition consists of works by one photographer, assign an additional heading for the name of the photographer.

K.2. Works belongs to an institution or private collection

If the photographs are a part of an institution's permanent collection, assign an additional heading for the institution with subdivision ***--Exhibitions*** in accordance with H 1593. If the photographs are identified as coming from an individual private collection, including a formerly private collection now belonging to a public institution, assign additional headings as specified in H 1427.

LC practice: If the photographs are a part of an institution's permanent collection, assign an additional heading for the institution, in accordance with H 1593. If the photographs are identified as coming from an individual private collection, including a formerly private collection now belonging to a public institution, assign additional headings as specified in H 1427.

Example:

```
Title: To be and not to be : Centre d'Art Santa Mònica, Barcelona, 23
d'abril del 1990.
```

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic.

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: A singular elegance : the photographs of Baron Adolph de Meyer.

650 #0 $a Fashion photography $v Exhibitions.

600 10 $a De Meyer, Adolf, $c Baron, $d 1868-1949 $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Fashion photography.

600 10 $a De Meyer, Adolf, $c Baron, $d 1868-1949.

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: Camera portraits : photographs from the National Portrait Gallery, London, 1839-1989.

650 #0 $a Portrait photography $v Exhibitions.

610 20 $a National Portrait Gallery (Great Britain) $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Portrait photography.

610 20 $a National Portrait Gallery (Great Britain)

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: Photographs from the collection of Dr. & Mrs. Sheldon Barnett : October 24, 1986-January 11, 1987.

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic $x Private collections $v Exhibitions.

600 10 $a Barnett, Sheldon $x Photograph collections $v Exhibitions.

600 10 $a Barnett, Sheldon, $c Mrs. $x Photograph collections $v Exhibitions.

650 #0 $a Photograph collections $z Wisconsin $z Milwaukee $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic $x Private collections.

600 10 $a Barnett, Sheldon $x Photograph collections.

600 10 $a Barnett, Sheldon, $c Mrs. $x Photograph collections.

650 #0 $a Photograph collections $z Wisconsin $z Milwaukee.

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Title: Selections from the Strauss photography collection, Denver Art Museum, July 10-November 14, 1982.

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic $v Exhibitions.

610 20 $a Denver Art Museum $v Exhibitions.

600 10 $a Strauss, Joyce $x Photograph collections $v Exhibitions.

600 10 $a Strauss, Ted $x Photograph collections $v Exhibitions.

650 #0 $a Photograph collections $z Colorado $z Denver $v Exhibitions.

LC practice:

650 #0 $a Photography, Artistic.

610 20 $a Denver Art Museum.

600 10 $a Strauss, Joyce $x Photograph collections.

600 10 $a Strauss, Ted $x Photograph collections.

650 #0 $a Photograph collections $z Colorado $z Denver.

655 #7 $a Exhibition catalogs. $2 lcgft

Revision history

2026-07: Updated template. Added alternative instructions for LCGFT implementation.